time. When Babur had just begun to fear the possible revolt from the deserters, Tulun was sent to counsel them to avoid any swaying of their position.

While he was still on the way, Auzun got the hint and sent a skirmishing party that killed Tulun. Auzun and Ahmad took a sigh of relief, and after taking Jahangir Mīrzā with them, proceeded to besiege Andijān.

Andijān Is Lost

Babur had bestowed the responsibilities of Andijān's security in the hands of Auzun Hassan while leaving for Samarkand in May of AD 1497.

During his stay in Samarkand, after the deserters had gone, letters had begun coming from Khwaja and his mother about how Auzun and Ahmad Tambal were leading the siege of Samarkand. Babur's mother wanted him to come as soon as possible. She wrote in one letter, 'Samarkand was taken by the strength of Andijān; if Andijān is in your hands, Allah willing, Samarkand can be had again.' [*]

Multiple letters kept reaching Babur, who was recovering from illness. The sad and worrying news pouring from letters sent by his mother aggravated his sickness. He was broken mentally and physically. His speech was impeded for four days. Such was his condition that he was being provided water through cotton. Every brave man and beg who was by Babur's side had begun to lose hope. While Babur remained in this condition, a servant of Auzun Hasan brought in a message with a wild proposal. Babur did not speak anything but dismissed the messenger after instructing his servant.

By the next week, Babur's condition had bettered; however, he was still unable to speak anything.

Yet the letters kept coming from his maternal grandmother which was turning him more and more anxious. So were the letters from his mentor and spiritual guide Khwaja-i-Maulana-i-Qazi who too implored for Babur's arrival in Andijān. The words were so horrifying and deep that Babur was deeply moved.

Finally, with partial recovery, and having ruled for around fourteen weeks, Babur and the party made a move to Andijān from Samarkand in the month of Rajab (February–March) of AD 1498. It was a Saturday. They reached Khujand after seven days. This is when a bad piece of news